DO YOU KNOW?

Goods: Goods are those products which we buy to fulfill our needs. It includes items of daily consumptions like milk, pencils, vegetable etc.

Services: Services are those facilities which are provided by government or non-government agencies free of cost or on payment. For example- electricity, water, health, education etc

2.3.1 Problems Related to Products

The consumer faces a number of serious problems with prices, quality and weights or volumes of products available in the market. Profit motive in any business is not a crime while, making profit through illegal trading like black marketing, adulteration etc., and objectionable malpractices such as deceptive packaging, short-weighing etc., are considered as unfair business practices. The Monopolistic and Restrictive Trade Practice (MRTP) Act 1969 offers legal protections to consumers against list of unfair trade practices such as

i) Lack of safety and absence of quality control regulations
ii) Adulteration
iii) Imitation manufacture
iv) Unfair warranties
v) Sales gimmicks
vi) Substandard quality
vii) Incorrect weights and measures
viii) Deceptive goods
ix) Misleading advertisements
x) Incorrect and incomplete labels
xi) Deceptive packaging
xii) Dishonest vending

These practices pose a problem to consumers. Unless these practices are restricted they are likely to continue to exploit the consumers.

i) Lack of Safety and Quality Control Regulations

Any defective functioning of equipment can affect the safety of the consumers. People can sustain injuries through shock, fire while using defective appliances or due to absence of adequate information on safe handling of defective equipment. e.g., household appliances and equipments, electrical and mechanical devices.



ii) Adulteration

Adulteration implies that some substances are either added or removed from a product as a result of which its composition, nature or quality gets altered. And when product is prepared without changing its composition, but kept under insanitary conditions and later gets sold in

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